

SAINT BONAVENTURE'S MONASTERY.

Detroit, Michigan.

November 17th 1942.

Mrs. Margaret LeDoux.
1532 16th Ave.
Oakland, California.

My Dear Sister Margaret Therese:-

God bless you and yours. I hope you and all the folks are well. I just finished your letter of two weeks ago - was in the hospital just a novena of weeks. I had been fighting grip(p)e for about five days when on September 13 I awoke "doubllly downed", having forgotten the night before to apply ointment or salve to feet after using electric light on vericose eczima around ankels.

I started to say holy Mass Nov. 10 - just a week To-day. Came back to St. Bonaventure's after offering the 8 o'clock Mass, as I announced for all benefactors - especially for "all in the Hospital - sisters, nurses, orderlies, patients, etc including my poor self". That was last Sunday, Nov. 15th.

Of course I had to limp around on the Altar pretty much, but thanks be to God got through without any serious difficulty. The old foot is still stiff but by keeping it raised and rested it causes very little pain. I'm resting it on the bed now and though it gets tire-some sitting in one position - well anyone over sixty need not be told how the "rear fenders" cry for better padding. If I remember rightly you were 61 on September 23rd. You were the only one of the family borne in the "new house" in Trimbelle.

When we - Fr. Maurice, Edward and myself - visited the old Trimbelle - farm five years ago we ran past the old log-house-knoll before we knew it. We had made an agreement the night before - the day of the Celebration in Prescott - with an old neighbor, Alex Hupret (83 at the time), that we would take dinner with him next day on condition, as Fr. E'd put it: "that you allow me to pitch bundles for an hour". Its Hupert's farm now. A man by name Weldel bought it from us. Poor, dear, old man wept when he met us, having waited for us out at dear, old St. Mary's in "Big-river" (now dried up) where Fr. M. and I were to stay over night and go back for the funeral of an in-law of ours - a little nephew of Nellie (O'Brien) Casey's. We retraced our wheeling and found our host across the road and only about ten rods West of the said old place. After dinner, with an understanding that I'd meet them over at the old spring, I left them to go and pitch their bundles - not that I would not have enjoyed same myself - I started for the old "Big-Ravine", thinking, I'd visit the scenes where we had sixty and more years herded the cattle, studded our catechism, picked nuts and wild fruits and were chased by all kinds of wild animals-even imaginary ones. I was disapointed.